C-E-00219?(Army-GL)
December 16, 1983

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

EGG LOAF WITH MUSHROOMS, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This Interim Federal specification was developed by the US Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers egg loaf with mushrooms thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
JJJ-S-30	-	Salad Oil, Vegetable
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, and other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Forth Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

FSC 8940

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specifications for

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

Regulations Governing the Inspection of Eggs and Egg Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms

(Application for copies should be addressed to Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Division, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to Director, Food Quality Assurance Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Academy of Sciences

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Copies may be obtained from the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 601 California Street, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, and wholesome. Unless otherwise specified herein or in referenced documents, all ingredients shall be free from foreign material, evidence of rodent and insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Whole eggs. The whole eggs may be liquid or frozen and shall have been processed in accordance with Regulations Governing the Inspection of Eggs and Egg Products. The whole eggs shall have been prepared from egg yolks and egg whites in their natural proportions as broken directly from the shell egg as evidenced by a USDA Egg Products Inspection Certificate. The whole eggs shall contain no additives, and shall be in satisfactory condition, free of

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objectionable odors, such as musty, sour, or fruity, and free from foreign material. Liquid egg products shall be held at a temperature of 40°F or lower and shall not be held more than 72 hours from time of pasteurization until the start of formulation of the eggs with mushrooms. Frozen whole eggs shall be held at 10°F or lower and used within 120 days. Thawed, previously frozen, egg products shall be held at a temperature of 40°F or lower and shall not be held for more than 24 hours prior to use in processing.

3.2.2 Celery, dehydrated, sliced. The dehydrated sliced celery shall be obtained from clean, sound pascal type celery. The slices shall be 1/8 to 3/8 inch cross-cut stalk slices with no leaf cuts. The slices shall be free flowing with a uniform bright color.

3.2.3 Citric acid. The citric acid shall be Food Chemicals Codex grade.

3.2.4 Color, yellow. The yellow color shall be a water soluble alkaline solution of the extract of annatto bixa orellana. The specific gravity shall be between 1.02 to 1.05 with a color equivalency of 1.5 percent to 1.7 percent Bixin.

3.2.5 Fresh cream cheese. The fresh cream cheese shall conform to the Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, Standard of Identity for Cream Cheese. The cream cheese shall have a delicate butterlike or creamy flavor, shall be moderately salted, shall have a comparatively light texture, reasonably firm body, no free whey, and shall be uniformly creamy-white in color. It may have a very slight, clean, acid flavor and aroma or slight cooked flavor, but shall be free from bitter, sour, flat, yeasty, or moldy flavors. The body and texture shall not be coarse, crumbly, excessively smooth, gummy, grainy, sticky, overfirm, or too soft. The cream cheese shall be in excellent condition, free of mold, slime, discoloration or burnt particles.

3.2.6 Microcrystalline cellulose. Microcrystalline cellulose shall be a gel forming cellulose composed of 85 parts microcrystalline cellulose and 15 parts sodium carboxymethylcellulose. It shall be a white, water dispersible powder which shall retain less than 0.1 percent on a standard 60 mesh screen and less than 50 percent on a standard 325 mesh screen and have an average particle size of 28 microns in dispersion. The microcrystalline cellulose shall have an ash content of not more than 2 percent and a heavy metals content of less than 10 parts per million. The pH of a 2 percent dispersion shall be not less than 6 nor more than 8 and shall have an acid demand requiring 2.2 milliliters of 0.1 normal hydrochloric acid to change the pH of 100 milliliters of 1 percent solids dispersion to a pH of 4. The microcrystalline cellulose shall be insoluble in water and organic solvents, but shall be dispersible in water to form colloidal sols and gels.

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3.2.7 Mushroom stems and pieces. Mushroom stems and pieces shall be prepared from clean, sound, edible mushrooms. The mushrooms shall be U.S. Grade B or better in accordance with U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms.

3.2.8 Onions, dehydrated, chopped. Dehydrated chopped onions shall comply with the standard grade of the Official Standards and Methods of Analysis of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association.

3.2.9 Pepper, white. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or outer and inner coverings have been removed. Volatile oil content shall be not less than 1 milliliter per 100 grams.

3.2.10 Vegetable oil. The vegetable oil shall be cottonseed oil, or corn oil, or a combination thereof and shall comply with the commodity requirements for type B of JJJ-S-30.

3.2.11 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

3.2.12 Water. Water used for formulation and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.3 Preparation and processing. The eggs with mushrooms shall be prepared from the following ingredients:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Whole eggs, pasteurized	58.09
Mushrooms, stems and pieces	12.00
Water	7.88
Brine from mushrooms	7.87
Fresh cream cheese	4.50
Onions, rehydrated, chopped	4.00
Celery, rehydrated, sliced	2.00
Vegetable oil	2.00
Microcrystalline cellulose	0.80
Salt	0.70
Pepper, white	0.06
Citric acid	0.05
Color, yellow	0.05
	100.00

The product shall be prepared as follows:

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a. The microcrystalline cellulose (M.C.) shall be combined with all of the water and mixed in equipment that provides a high degree of shear, such as homogenizers, vertical-cutter mixers. Planetary mixers, lightening mixers, or similar equipment shall not be used. Proper dispersion of M.C. in water shall be demonstrated by a pudding-like (gel-like) consistency and a flow on a Cenco (Bostwick) Viscosimeter of 1.5 to 5.0 cm at 70°F in 3 minutes.

b. The mushrooms shall be drained thoroughly, then ground through a 1/4 inch plate. The mushroom brine shall be saved.

c. The cream cheese shall be mixed with mushroom brine to produce a thin slurry. The slurry shall be heated to 140°F with continuous stirring in a steam-jacketed kettle until the cheese is completely dissolved. The citric acid, pepper, salad oil, salt and yellow color shall be added and thoroughly mixed.

d. The celery and onions shall be rehydrated in an excess of water then thoroughly drained before use.

e. The cream cheese slurry and the eggs shall be gradually added to the M.C. gel (failure to thin the M.C. gel gradually will result in gel lumps which cannot be broken up). The ground mushrooms and the rehydrated celery and onions shall then be slowly added and mixed only until fully dispersed in the egg/cream cheese/M.C. gel mixture. In addition, final mixing of the product shall be at a slow speed to reduce the occurence of air pockets in the finished product.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with eggs and mushrooms such as to conform to the finished product requirements. Each can shall be hermetically sealed (under a vacuum of not less than 10 inches of mercury) immediately after filling.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved. NOTE: A minimum of 24 psi overriding air pressure is recommended to avoid damage to the tray cans.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not restricted to glass, paint, metal, dirt, insect, insect parts, wood, or paper.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not restricted to rancid, scorched, burnt, stale, sour, musty, moldy, or strong sulfurous odor or flavor.

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c. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

d. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

e. The product shall possess a typical yellow cooked egg color.

f. There shall be no undissolved particles of cream cheese.

g. There shall be not more than 1 ounce of free liquid in any can.

h. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

i. There shall be no visible lumps of microcrystalline cellulose gel.

3.6.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged under sanitary conditions in accordance with good manufacturing practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the sanitary requirements of the applicable Government inspection agency.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsiblity to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

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4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1 Ingredient examination. Conformance of ingredients to identity and condition requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, US Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or of any involved product.

4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest ounce. If the average weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.2 Product inspection. Eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot. The eight tray packs shall be heated for 15 minutes in 140° to 150°F water, opened, and inspected in accordance with table I.

a. If no defects are found, the lot shall be acceptable.

b. If two or more defects are found, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If only one defect is found, a second sample of eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot, heated as above, and inspected for the defects listed in table I. If any defect, is found in the second sample, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE I. Product inspection 1/ 2/ 3/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Presence of undissolved particles of cream cheese.
152	Presence of visible lumps of microcystalline cellulose gel.
153	The presence of more than 1 ounce of free liquid in a tray pack can.
154	Does not possess a typical yellow cooked egg color.

1/ The presence of any foreign material e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.) foreign or strong sulfur odor or flavor e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. This comparison shall only be performed when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ To determine the weight of free liquid and to inspect for product characteristics and extraneous material, the can shall be opened and, with the lid held in place, the free liquid shall be decanted into a tared container allowing 1 minute for draining to occur. The product shall be divided into ten approximately equal portions and the surfaces of the portions examined for product characteristics and appearance.

4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers except that the inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 see 5.4).

4.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: 1) Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; 2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; 3) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used; 4) Height of box liner less than inside dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above the top edge of box.

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4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of the food product, sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be full length and width and be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. Each fiberboard box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure sensitive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be full length and width and be fabricated of the same material as the box.

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5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the name of product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 size of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.7 after submerging the can in boiling water for 30 minutes. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Remove from water and open lid for serving.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.

WARNING: Do not place closed can in oven as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

YIELD

Approximately 20 servings (5 ounces each) per tray pack can cut 4 slices in width by 5 slices in length.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

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a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is required see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of packaging and packing required see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-A436

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
C-E-002197(Army-GL)	Egg Loaf With Mushrooms, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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